The Westover Villas ... From St. Peter's Spire



This view of the Westover Villas was taken by William Day, from the top of scaffolding erected to add the spire to the tower of St. Peter's church. That information allows us to date the photograph to 1879.

It's an interesting view of the rear of the Villas from an aerial perspective, and illustrates just how elaborate the structure of some villas were. The villas had been standing for some 40 years by this time, and I think it's reasonable to assume that ancillary buildings had been added by that time – although I can imagine that dramatic changes to the front view of any Villa may well have been frowned upon – even before modern planning laws were in place!

Villas numbered 1, 2 and 3 are off to the right of the photo. So we only see part of number 4, and then the rear aspect all the others.

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